

LATEEF ADETUNJI ADELEKE

✉ ladeleke@ur.rochester.edu 📍 515 Lattimore Hall, Rochester, NY. 🔗 LinkedIn 🔗 lateefadeleke.github.io

RESEARCH INTEREST

Language Description and Documentation, Speech Technology, Natural Language Processing

EDUCATION

PhD in Linguistics 2023 – present

University of Rochester

Advisor: Nadine Grimm

QP1: Negation in Uhami.

Committee Members: Nadine Grimm, Asia Pietraszko, Joyce McDonough, Hannah Sande.

QP2: An Automatic Speech Recognition (ASR) for Uneme.

Committee Members: Agatha Downey and Nadine Grimm.

Master's Degree in Linguistics (Awarded upon PhD candidacy) 2026

University of Rochester

Bachelor of Arts in Linguistics (First Class Honors) 2015 – 2019

Adekunle Ajasin University, Akungba-Akoko.

Project: Syntactic and Pragmatic Analysis of Questions in Efunroye Tinubu

Advisor: Simeon Olaogun

GRANTS/AWARDS

2026 NLDSTC Indigenous NLP Excellence Award 2026

Nigerian Languages Data and Sci-Tech Conference

Endangered Languages Documentation Programme- IGS1048 (€91,267) 🔗 2025 – 2028

Project: Documentation of Uneme Indigenous Iron Technology.

Donald M. and Janet C. Barnard Fellowship (\$3000) 🔗

Recognizes outstanding achievement for one graduate student in engineering or natural science disciplines.

Award for Nigeria's Exceptional Fresh Graduates, i-Scholar Initiative 🔗 2022

Covered costs for standardized tests (GRE and TOEFL), and graduate school application fees.

Vice Chancellor's Prize for Overall Best Graduating Student (#150,000) 🔗 2021

Adekunle Ajasin University, Akungba-Akoko, Ondo State (Nigeria).

Clement Bamiduro's Prize for Overall Best Graduating Student (#100,000) 🔗 2021

Adekunle Ajasin University.

Faculty Prize for Best Graduating Student in the Faculty of Arts. (#100,000) 🔗 2021

Adekunle Ajasin University, Akungba-Akoko, Ondo State (Nigeria).

Dare Akande Vanguard Scholarship. 2019

Tuition support for exceptional undergraduate students from Okeogun.

NALLS Tutor of the Year 🔗 2019

National Association of Linguistics and Languages Students Association (NALLS), Adekunle Ajasin University.

Best Student in Okeogun 2019

Progressive Movement of Okeogun.

Winner, Fitrah Review Competition, Poetry Category 🔗 2019

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

MCFG_Parser: A Python Package for Parsing Natural Languages with Multiple Context-Free Grammars (MCFGs)

2024

Project: Developed a Python package that implements an agenda-based parser to efficiently handle complex syntactic structures, including discontinuous categories in human language.

Advisor: Aron White

Collaborator, Grammar and Variation Lab, University of Rochester

2023 – present

Ongoing Research: Tense, Aspect, and Polarity in West African Languages.

Advisor: Nadine Grimm

Collaborator, Science in Yoruba

2021 – present

Ongoing Project: Building an Online Archive to Promote STEM Education in Yoruba, and Translating STEM content into Yoruba for secondary school students.

Director: Taofeek Adebayo

FIELD EXPERIENCE

- Conducted an ELDP-sponsored fieldwork on Uneme in Ekpedo, Edo state, Nigeria.
- Uhami (Edoid): Conducted fieldwork in Isua Akoko, Ondo state, Nigeria.
- Igasi (Benue-Congo, Nigeria): Conducted fieldwork on Igasi, Ondo state, Nigeria.

LAB AFFILIATIONS

- Member, Grammar and Variation Lab, University of Rochester
- Member, Fieldsyntax Lab, University of Rochester

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Linguistics Department, University of Rochester

2025

Course: Language and Culture

Teaching Assistant, Linguistics Department, University of Rochester

2025

Course: Linguistic Analysis

Tutor, National Association of Linguistics and Languages Students, AAUA

2016 – 2019

Courses: Phonetics, Phonology and Syntax

Tutor, Faculty of Arts Student Association (FASA), Adekunle Ajasin University.

2016 – 2019

Courses: First year students' courses on communication in English (GST111 & GST122) and Philosophy, Logic, and Human Existence (LIN112)

PUBLICATIONS

Chen, Fei-Yueh, Adeleke, Lateef, & C. M. Downey (2026). Linguistically informed evaluation of multilingual ASR for African languages. In *Proceedings of the 7th Workshop on African Natural Language Processing (AfricaNLP 2026), EACL 2026, Rabat, Morocco, 149–162. ACL.*

Adeleke, Lateef. & Olaogun, Simeon. (2025) NPI-Licensing: The case of N-kankan in Yoruba. *Ekiti Journal of Language, Literature and Culture* 

Olaogun, Simeon. & Adeleke, Lateef. (2022) A Pragmatic Analysis of Questions in Efunroye Tinubu. *Language Review An International Journal of Linguistics.* 181-184 

Simeon, Olaogun & Adeleke, Lateef (2022) Pragmatic Functions of Rhetorical Questions in Efunroye Tinubu. *Journal of Yoruba Studies Association of Nigeria* -222-235 

PRESENTATIONS

Adeleke, L. 2026. Reflexes of Movement in Uhami, ACAL 57, University at Buffalo

Adeleke, L. 2026. Polarity-conditioned Asymmetries in Uneme, ACAL 57, University at Buffalo

2026

Linguistically Informed Evaluation of Multilingual ASR for African Languages, AfricaNLP Workshop at EACL 2026, Rabat, Morocco.

2026

Adeleke, L. 2026. "Reflexes of Movement in Uneme" at the 55th Colloquium on African Languages and Linguistics, Leiden

Adeleke, L.A. 2025. "The Morphosyntax of Tense in Uhami". Presented at the Field Syntax Lab, Department of Linguistics, University of Rochester.

Adeleke, L.A. 2025. "The Morphosyntax of Tense in Uhami". Talk at the 56th Association of Contemporary African Linguistics (ACAL, 56) Conference. University of Minnesota Twin Cities.

Adeleke, L.A. 2025. "Tense and Aspect in Uhami". Presented at the Ph2 Lab, Department of Linguistics, University of Rochester.

Adeleke, L.A. 2025. "Negation in Uhami". Presented at the Field Syntax Lab, Department of Linguistics, University of Rochester.

Adeleke, L. "Pragmatic Functions of Rhetorical Questions in Efunroye Tinubu." 2nd National Universities Linguistics Students' Annual Conference, University of Lagos.

05/2025

05/2025

03/2025

02/2025

2019

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND CERTIFICATIONS

Language Documentation and Archiving Training, Berlin, Germany

Participated in the 2025 ELDP Training by the Endangered Languages Documentation Programme.

Certified Participant, Summer School in Language Science and Technology, Warsaw, Poland

Completed courses in Phonetics and Speech Technology and Natural Language Processing, earning 3.5 ECTS

Introduction to Programming with python

Via edu

NLP- Natural Language Processing with Python

Via Udemy

TESOL and TPRS Course (For Language Teachers)

Via Udemy

The Melody of English

Via Udemy

The Python Programming

Via Udemy

06/2025

2024

2024

2024

2022

2022

2022

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Editor-in-Chief

Dailyinsiderng

Office Assistant, Vice-Chancellor's office, Obafemi Awolowo University

02/2023 – 08/2023

01/2022 – 11/2022

LEADERSHIP RESPONSIBILITIES

Team Lead, Daily Insider

General Secretary, Okeogun People's Award

Financial Secretary

Student Ambassador

2023

2021 – 08/2023

2021 – 2022

2018 – 2019

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Member, Organizing Committee, Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT34), University of Rochester.

Member, Association of Contemporary African Linguistics

Member, Association for Computational Linguistics

2024

2023 – present

2026 – Present

SKILLS

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python.

Annotation: ELAN, FLex, Praat.

Typesetting: LaTeX, Word, Excel, PowerPoint.

Corpus Tools: Antconc, Search Engine.

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Yoruba: Native Speaker.

English: Bilingual Proficiency.

Nigerian Pidgin: Native Speaker.